

vtslides API

vtslides — lay out whole pages in Typst, mark what should morph, and let the browser do the rest.

The identity channel is a **label**: the SVG export turns `<lb>` into a `<g data-typst-label>` wrapping the content, so the subtree is the boundary; on the PDF side a label costs nothing, so nothing is gated by backend.

Three words. A **transition** is a change of layout state (page to page, frame to frame) and runs on the View Transitions API. An **element animation** is one object varying with a parameter (mark with several states, stepped with `-`) and runs on Web Animations. A **continuous animation** is an object moving on its own, without keys (`slide(anim:)`). The test is one sentence: did the layout change, or is one object moving? Design trade-offs and browser pitfalls are in the README.

vtslides

- mark()
- deck()
- reveal()
- layers()
- build()
- slide()

Variables

- transitions
- anim-defaults

mark

Give a piece of content a name. The same key on two adjacent pages makes the browser pair them and interpolate — position, size, colour, rotation. This is a **transition**: the layout changed.

Several bodies make an **element animation**: N states of the same object. While presenting, `-` moves from one state to the next and `-` back along the same path; the page turns only once the states are exhausted. Between states nothing cross-fades — the object's own geometry moves: the browser (Web Animations) interpolates between the corresponding SVG nodes of two states, the path's `d`, transform, colours, stroke width, opacity. So the states must be **the same drawing under different parameters** — same structure, same number of elements, only the numbers differ; write a function `f(t)` and feed it a few values of `t`:

```
#mark("wave", ..range(0, 6).map(t => wave(t)))
```

In a formula, hand the term over as an equation — `$ #mark("sq")($x^2$) + #mark("lin")($b x$) = c $` — not as bare math: a mark boxes what it is given, and a box lays its content out as markup, which would set `b x` upright in the body font. An equation inside an equation is transparent, so the term is typeset exactly as it would be unmarked, and the operators around it keep their spacing. What is left unmarked is the page's: `+` and `=` cross-fade with it, which is invisible where they stay put and a double image where they move.

What has no in-between — text that changes, a path against an arc, states whose element count differs — cross-fades. The PDF has no player and shows the last state (the finished figure, like a handout). In the HTML the other states are stacked on the first state's box (place, taking no layout space) and hidden by the runtime as data.

If the page's `slide(anim:)` names the same key, the states become the keyframes of a continuous animation, played over time instead of stepped; the PDF then shows the first state (the page at rest).

The inner `box` is not decoration, and not a preference: a label attaches to the element before it, and of everything that can stand in a paragraph only `box` and `block` carry one into the SVG as a `<g data-typst-label>`. Put the label on a `rect`, a `circle`, a `cetz` canvas, an equation, `emph` or bare text and the export writes no group at all — the mark would silently not exist. Between the two, `block` is out: it is block-level, and a mark has to work on a word inside a sentence and on a term inside a formula; it is also breakable, and a mark split over two lines has no single box to interpolate.

A box does wrap its content, like ordinary text. But it is atomic, so one that does not fit the rest of the line moves to a line of its own: marking a word, a title, a term or a figure costs nothing, while marking a whole sentence in the middle of running prose reflows the paragraph around it.

Parameters

```
mark(
  key: str,
  transition: none str dictionary,
  ..states: content
) -> content
```

key `str`

The name. Same name on two adjacent pages = one pair. Letters, digits, `_` and `-` (it becomes a CSS view-transition-name).

transition `none` or `str` or dictionary

This object's own enter/leave effect: a name from transitions, the same both ways, or (enter: name, leave: name) — enter is how it appears, leave how it disappears (going back replays either in reverse). It applies only when the mark is one-sided in a transition; a paired mark morphs regardless. "wipe-up" reveals from the bottom edge up, "slide" pushes in from the right (by its own width, fading as it goes), "zoom" shrinks into place, "none" appears at once. Unset (none) folds the mark into the page: within a page it cross-fades with the layout, between pages it pushes, wipes or fades with the whole page. Definition, theorem and proof each revealed from a different edge is three marks with one value each. One object has one effect: given on any occurrence of the key, it holds for all of them, and two occurrences may not disagree. Marks nest: one around an assembly is a group of its own, and the marks inside it keep their own identity — what the group carries is what is left once they are lifted out, which is how the first change's result takes part in the next one as a whole (see `fit` and anchor in transitions). Settings ride along in the same dictionary (duration, easing, zoom, push; see transitions) and apply to this mark alone, whatever pace the page keeps.

Default: `none`

..states `content`

One body is a plain mark; several bodies are the states of the object.

deck

The deck: page size, fonts, and on the HTML side the stylesheet and the runtime.

#show: `deck.with(title: "...")`. One compile gives the PDF, one with `--features html` the HTML; side by side under one name, the toolbar's download link finds the PDF.

Parameters

```
deck(
  title: str,
  width: length,
  height: length,
  pdf: auto none str,
  duration: int,
  easing: array,
  transition: none str dictionary,
  theme: auto str,
  fill: color,
  font: array,
  body: content
) -> content
```

title `str`

Document title.

Default: `"vtslides"`

width `length`

Layout width. The PDF page size; in the HTML every frame's `html.frame` is the same size — `slide` reads `page.width / page.height`, nothing is hard-coded.

Default: `1280pt`

height `length`

Layout height.

Default: `720pt`

pdf `auto` or `none` or `str`

Target of the toolbar's PDF download link. `auto` = the `.pdf` with the HTML's name, `none` = no button, a string is used as is.

Default: `auto`

duration `int`

Transition duration in milliseconds. Adjustable live with `- / = 0`.

Default: `700`

easing `array`

Transition easing: the two control points of a cubic Bézier, as in CSS `cubic-bezier(x1, y1, x2, y2)`. (0, 0, 1, 1) is linear. Used for page transitions and element-animation steps alike.

Default: `(0.32, 0.72, 0, 1)`

transition `none` or `str` or dictionary

The default **page-to-page** transition — how unmarked content enters and leaves when turning to another page: a name from transitions, the same both ways, or (enter: name, leave: name) — enter for the page being entered, leave for the page being left. Paired marks morph regardless; one-sided marks without an effect of their own fold into the page. The effect "none" switches that side at once while the transition runs (so marks still morph); `none` runs no transition between pages at all. Not used between frames of one page: there the layout stays put and only changes incrementally, so root cross-fades and elements enter and leave by `mark(transition:)`. A single page can override it with `slide(transition:)`. The dictionary may carry settings for this transition as well — duration, easing, zoom, push; see transitions.

Default: `"fade"`

theme `auto` or `str`

Light/dark theme of the player chrome (toolbar, overview, speaker view). `auto` follows the system, "dark" / "light" fix it. Chrome only; the layout's colours are Typst's.

Default: `auto`

fill `color`

Layout background. The PDF uses `page(fill:); html.frame` carries no page background, so the same value opens the stylesheet as `--vt-page` and is painted under the slides and thumbnails — identical on both sides, and independent of the chrome theme.

Default: `rgb("#111318")`

font `array`

Font stack, glyph-by-glyph fallback in order. The default carries a CJK family for a reason: with a Latin family alone, CJK text falls back glyph by glyph to whatever system family has the glyph, and weights differ within one line.

Default: `("DejaVu Sans", "Noto Sans CJK SC")`

body `content`

The pages.

reveal

Frames from one description, written once. `reveal(3, (step, at) => ...)` renders the body once per frame — `step` is which frame it is, 1 to `n` — and at `(k, x)` is `x` from frame `k` on. Before then it holds `x`'s space if `x` is content, so the layout never moves and nothing jumps, and is `none` otherwise, which is how a stroke or a fill is switched off:

```
s\lide(..reveal(3, (step, at) => diagram({
  node(0, 0), $As)
  node(1, 0), at(2, mark("b", transition: "zoom"))[$Bs])
  edge(0, 0), at(2, $fs), "->", stroke: at(2, lpt))
}))
```

Everything is written where it belongs, each part says when it arrives, and because what has not arrived still takes its space, every frame is laid out identically — which is what lets the marks morph instead of the page re-flowing under them.

Parameters

```
reveal(
  n: int,
  body: function
) -> array
```

n `int`

How many frames.

body `function`

Called once per frame with the frame's number and `at`.

layers

Layers of one picture, hung from the corner they share. Each layer is a mark of its own — key-1, key-2, ... — so a layer that is on two frames keeps its identity: if a later layer makes the picture bigger, the earlier one glides to where it now sits instead of being redrawn. The last layer sizes the stack and the ones before it hang from `align`; a none layer is left out, which is how one arrives:

```
layers("pb", meet: bottom + right, the-square, if step >= 3 { the-cone })
```

`meet` is where the layers meet: the corner the arriving layer does not push — `bottom + right` for a picture that grows up and to the left, `top + left` for one that grows down and to the right, and for growth on two sides at once the corner opposite both. It has to be said, because it cannot be worked out here. Lining the layers up by the point they share needs that point's **position** in each, and HTML export does not give positions: sizes are there (`measure` and `layout` both answer inside a frame) but every position reads as zero, alike for two elements 60pt apart. That is Typst's own line — "Introspection (except for concrete positions)", the HTML export tracking issue, `typst512` — and the PDF target reports them properly. When it lifts, this can be derived and `meet` becomes optional. Until then, if no corner holds (growth on opposite sides, by different amounts) nothing can hold the layers together: keep the layout still with `reveal` instead and let nothing move.

A layer that is a drawing keeps its own picture only if the package lays it out the same way each time, so a later layer that must reach into an earlier one draws that one's anchors hidden.

Parameters

```
layers(
  key: str,
  meet: alignment,
  ..parts: content none
) -> content
```

key `str`

Names the stack; each layer's mark key is this and its place in it.

meet `alignment`

Where the layers meet — the corner the arriving layer does not push.

Default: `none`

..parts `content` or `none`

The layers, back to front.

build

Frames that accumulate. `build(a, b, c)` is three frames — `a`, then `a` and `b`, then all three — so what stays on the page is written once and the source reads as what each step adds:

```
s\lide(title: "Cauchy sequences", ..build(
  definition,
  [#v(14pt) #theorem],
  [#v(14pt) #proof],
))
```

Content in, content out, so it builds the body of a drawing just as well: `..build(cospan, square, cone).map(diagram)`.

Parameters

```
build(..parts: content) -> array
```

..parts `content`

The parts, in the order they appear.

slide

One page. On the HTML side a whole-page `html.frame` (hence pixel-identical to the PDF); on the PDF side a page.

Several bodies are **frames of the same page**: navigation walks them one by one, the overview merges them into one thumbnail with dots for the positions. Frames still transition with View Transitions, so "the second frame has one more line" is an element-level interpolation, not a page jump.

```
#slide(title: "Two frames")[first][first + something added]
```

Parameters

```
s\lide(
  title: content str none,
  note: content str none,
  transition: none str dictionary,
  anim: dictionary,
  ..frames: content
) -> content
```

title `content` or `str` or `none`

Shown only in the thumbnail caption, never in the layout. May be content.

Default: `none`

note `content` or `str` or `none`

Speaker notes. HTML only, placed in the page's `<aside class="vt-note">` (not in the layout, not in the PDF) and read by the desk the deck opens on and by the speaker view (s). May be content: paragraphs, lists, emphasis all render.

Default: `none`

transition `none` or `str` or dictionary

Overrides `deck(transition:)` for this page: a name from transitions, the same both ways, or (enter: name, leave: name) — enter is how this page comes in when turning to it, leave how the page before it goes out — with settings of its own if it wants them (duration, easing, zoom, push; see transitions). Not used between frames of this page; individual elements enter and leave by `mark(transition:)`. Going back, the page being left decides, so a transition always replays in reverse. `none` takes the deck's.

Default: `none`

anim `dictionary`

Continuous animation, running while the page rests on this frame. `key -> spec`. The options are duration (ms), delay (ms), iterations (none = without end), direction ("normal", "reverse", "alternate", "alternate-reverse") and easing (a cubic Bézier as in `deck(easing:)`, over each iteration); `anim-defaults` fills in the rest:

```
anim: (spin: keyframes: ((transform: "rotate(0)"), (transform: "rotate(1turn)")), duration: 4000))
```

Three sources of keyframes: `keyframes` animates the mark itself (transform, opacity, ...); (follow: "track", duration: 3000) runs the mark's centre along the first path of `mark("track")` on the same frame (a ball on a track), `orient: true` turns it with the tangent; with neither, and the mark of that key carrying several states, those states are the keyframes — the N poses one piece of code computed, played continuously (double pendulum, waves). Starts after the page transition, pauses when the frame is left.

Default: `(:)`

..frames `content`

The frames of this page. None at all is one blank page.

transitions `array`

Effect names. One is an effect for both sides of a transition; a pair (enter:, leave:) names the two sides separately. "fade" cross-fades; "slide" pushes horizontally (forward, the new page comes in from the right and the old one leaves to the left); "rise" pushes vertically (in from the bottom) — a page is pushed by the width or height of the screen and is gone when it arrives, a mark by its own, so a mark fades as it travels rather than winking out beside where it started; "zoom" scales about the centre (the new one shrinks into place from three times its size, fading in, the old one grows away, fading out) with the screen as the focal plane: whichever is larger than life is nearer than the focus, and a lens a quarter of the stage wide spreads each of its points over a circle that grows with the magnification, so a stroke thinner than the circle casts only a diluted shadow — text arrives as a haze and condenses as it lands; "wipe-left" / "wipe-right" / "wipe-up" / "wipe-down" reveal, named by the direction the front travels (wipe-up sweeps up from the bottom edge; the new page appears, the old one is covered); "none" switches at once. Going back always replays in reverse.

Everywhere a transition is given — `deck`, `slide`, `mark` — the dictionary may also carry settings for that one transition, next to the effects:

```
transition: (effect: "zoom", duration: 400, zoom: 6)
transition: (enter: "slide", leave: "fade", duration: 250, push: -100%)
transition: (enter: (effect: "slide", duration: 200), leave: (effect: "fade", duration: 900))
```

`effect` names one effect for both sides, `enter` and `leave` the two sides separately; a side may be a name or (effect: name, ..settings). Settings beside the effects belong to the whole transition — both sides and, on a paired mark, the group that carries it across; settings inside a side belong to that side alone and beat the shared ones, because they land on that image. Going back the two sides swap images, so the side that comes in always runs the enter side's settings. Duration is milliseconds, as in `deck(duration:);` easing is four numbers, as in `deck(easing:);` the rest are the effects' own knobs — `zoom`, how many times life size the zoom starts at, and `push`, how far slide and rise travel (negative sends them the other way).

`fit` and `anchor` are for a mark that is a whole assembly. A group interpolates as a box, and each of its two images is drawn into that box, stretched to fill it: right for something that keeps its shape, wrong for something that grows on one side, which smears while the box grows. `fit: "none"` draws both images at their own size instead, and `anchor (a Typst alignment, or the CSS pair) is the corner they are pinned to — the corner that does not move. That is how a diagram keeps what it already had, where it had it, while the rest arrives around it. A setting is a variable deck.css reads, so the stylesheet is the vocabulary for both halves and a typo is a compile error. The Typst side turns each bundle into one CSS rule and names it after what it holds; the name travels as a view transition type on the page's frames and as a view-transition-class on a mark. The presenter's speed keys still divide every duration, whoever writes it.`

anim-defaults

What a continuous animation runs with unless its spec says otherwise: `iterations: none` is without end.